

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What are Polygon's strengths and weaknesses? Let's find out!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can make positive and negative comments.
- I can ask for clarification and clarify meaning.
- I can talk about jobs and work.

Ask your partner:

- What are your strengths?
- What are your weaknesses?





Let's Explore!

Does Polygon have a competitive edge over the Garcias? Let's find out!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Miranda:** Janet and Peter, thanks for coming in. I was afraid you were not going to make it.
- Janet:** I was able to reschedule my meeting. So, what is this about?
- Miranda:** I'm here to brief you on our strengths and weaknesses. I started creating a SWOT analysis.
- Peter:** I beg your pardon? I'm not sure I follow you.
- Janet:** It is a simple tool for auditing an organization and its environment.
- Peter:** I'm not sure I know what you mean.
- Miranda:** To put it differently, it helps us analyze our strengths and weaknesses. One of our strengths is that we're the market leader and have been for the last two years ...
- Janet:** On the negative side, we are less experienced in the Latin American market.
- Miranda:** Perhaps a weakness is that we have little experience in this market. On the other hand, we have strong partnerships as well as a strong marketing team. This gives us a competitive edge.
- Janet:** I agree. Our other main weakness is the lack of information on the Latin American market. But actually this is where Miranda comes in.
- Miranda:** What are you trying to say? Could you clarify that, please?
- Peter:** Sorry, I'm not sure I am following you either.
- Janet:** I took a straw poll with our clients and hands down the top reason they gave us for using our services was the strong personal touch we're famous for. What I like about this is, Miranda, you have extensive experience in the fashion industry. And Peter, I want you to be in charge of writing up our SWOT analysis.



Let's Practice!

Miranda isn't sure*. What does she say?

**sure*: Another way to express lack of understanding is using the expression: I'm not quite "sure" what you are asking about.

Instructions: Organize the phrases below into the correct category.

- | | |
|--|------------------------------------|
| 1) I'm not sure I know what you mean. | 4) Could you clarify that, please? |
| 2) I'm not sure what you are asking about. | 5) I beg your pardon. |
| 3) Sorry, I'm not sure I'm following you either. | 6) I'm not sure I follow you. |

Expressing a lack of understanding	Asking for clarification



Let's Practice!

What did Janet mean by that?

Instructions: Read the following sentences. Classify them as positive signals (PS), negative signals (NS) or moving from a negative to a positive signal (MNP).

- | | |
|---|-------|
| 1. On the negative side, we are less experienced in the Latin American market. | _____ |
| 2. Our other main weakness is the lack of information on the Latin American market. | _____ |
| 3. But actually, this is where Miranda comes in! | _____ |
| 4. One of our strengths is that we are the market leader! | _____ |
| 5. What I like about this is that we know how our clients feel about our services! | _____ |
| 6. Then again, we are an influential PR team. | _____ |





Extension Activity

Explain your strengths and weaknesses when working in a team.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- What are your strengths and weaknesses when it comes to working in a team?
- With a partner, talk about positive and negative signals when it comes to working in a team.
- Make sure your partner understands all your points.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about my strengths and weaknesses.

☐ ☐

I talk about positive and negative signals.

☐ ☐

I provide clarification when needed.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to reschedule** (verb): to change the time of a planned event
e.g. I was able to reschedule my meeting.
- **to brief** (verb): to instruct someone on something
e.g. I'm here to brief you on the company's strengths and weaknesses.
- **strength** (noun): a person's good quality
e.g. My strength is my positive attitude.
- **weakness** (noun): a quality or feature regarded as a disadvantage
e.g. You must recognize your product's weaknesses.
- **to audit** (verb): to do a complete review
e.g. It is a simple tool for auditing an organization and its environment.
- **to analyze** (verb): to examine in detail
e.g. Let's analyze our strengths and weaknesses.
- **market leader** (noun): the company selling the largest number of a particular type of product
e.g. Our company is the market leader in PR.
- **partnership** (noun): the state of working closely with another person or group
e.g. We have strong partnerships with many other companies.
- **a competitive edge** (expression): an advantage that a company has over its competitors
e.g. Our strong marketing team gives us a competitive edge.
- **extensive** (adjective): covering or affecting a large area
e.g. You have extensive experience in the fashion industry.





Learning Points

Making Positive and Negative Comments

In the business world, it is important to talk about things that you like and things that you don't like. Here are some ways you can show your co-workers that you like some things but not others:

Phrases That Are Positive or Highlight Strengths	Phases That Are Negative or Highlight Weaknesses
• <i>On the positive side ...</i> • <i>What I like about this is ...</i> • <i>One of the strengths of this is ...</i> • <i>... is one of the strengths.</i> • <i>One of our strengths is ...</i>	• <i>On the negative side ...</i> • <i>Perhaps a weakness of this is that ...</i> • <i>This is one of the things I'm not sure of, because ...</i> • <i>... is one of the weaknesses.</i> • <i>Our other main weakness is ...</i>
Moving From Positive To Negative Or From Negative To Positive • <i>But actually, ...</i> • <i>On the other hand, ...</i> • <i>Then again, ...</i>	

Examples:

- **One of our strengths is** that we are leaders and pioneers in this market.
- **On the negative side,** we are not as experienced as our competitor in the South American market.
- **On the other hand,** we are a strong and influential marketing team.
- **Our other main weakness is** the lack of bilingual staff in our company.





Learning Points

Asking for Clarification and Clarifying Meaning

Sometimes you don't understand what was said or something was not clear to you. It is, therefore, important to express your lack of understanding and seek clarification from the person you are talking to.

Expressing a lack of understanding	Asking for clarification
• Sorry, I am not sure I am following you. • I beg your pardon, but I don't quite understand. • I beg your pardon, I'm not sure I follow you. • I'm not sure I know what you mean. • I'm not sure I follow you.	• Could you elaborate on that? • Could you be more specific? • Could you repeat that, please? • Could you clarify that, please? • Do you mean ... ? • What are you trying to say?